SPORTSAPI365 · FOOTBALL REST CATALOGUE

Football API Report

> **API:** `https://sports-api.sportsdata365.com/msdata/v1/football/`
>
> **Product:** Football Lab — a football app built on the SportsAPI365 Football REST catalogue (43 endpoints)
>
> **Scope:** REST GET only. No streaming, alerts, predictions, or third-party score comparison.

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This is the combined record of two pieces of work. First we built a real football product on the 43-route catalogue and walked every screen. Then we called every endpoint properly — pagination, errors, missing fields, coverage — and asked whether the payload can actually feed those screens.

The question throughout:

> Can someone ship a complete football product using only these 43 endpoints?

Short answer: yes for a first product, no for a complete match-centre experience without extra work. Search, teams, competitions, standings, match detail, incidents, and statistics work. Live home scores, lineups, injuries, weather, head-to-head, manager pages, and several match extras do not yet behave like a product API. Coverage also changes by match: the same path can be a full XI on one game and an empty shell or a 404 on another.

Nothing below was invented. Search and directories returned the ids. The product only rendered what the API gave us.

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1. What we built

Football Lab is a small football product a customer could reasonably expect from a sports data API:

Home (live / today / upcoming / finished) → **Matches** → **Match centre** → **Team** → **Player** → **Competition** → **Search**

It is not a production consumer app. It is the proof that the Football API can, or cannot, support those screens without extra work.

The stack is a Fastify BFF (`apps/api`) and a Vite + React UI (`apps/web`). Every product screen talks to our BFF (`/app/football/...`). The BFF talks to SportsAPI365, normalises the payload, and records a gap whenever a field, relationship, or filter the screen needs is missing, empty, 404, slow, or shaped differently from another route. The UI is thin: it never calls the provider directly.

That split was deliberate. List routes and detail routes do not share one schema. Search and today's fixtures use `items`. Player and team match lists use `events`. Squad uses `players`. Player match stats use `playerStatistics`. Seasons use `seasons`. Status is a string on lists and an object on detail. Kickoff is unix seconds on lists. A UI that consumed the raw feed would have to special-case every screen. The BFF does that once, and records the special case as a gap.

The app runs locally as two processes:

- Web UI: `http://127.0.0.1:5174`
- BFF: `http://127.0.0.1:8788`

Admin tools sit at `/admin/gaps`, `/admin/coverage`, `/admin/endpoint-lab`, and `/admin/report`.

Screen loaders were written against a product contract, not against "HTTP 200." A live home card is expected to have teams, status, kickoff, score, and competition. A lineup tab is expected to have 11 starters, player ids, positions, shirts, and a formation. When the provider does not meet the contract, the loader still tries to render the screen: it may call `/event/{id}` for each live row that has no score, it may hide a tab on a 404, and it may show "data unavailable" when an envelope is empty. Those workarounds keep the product usable. They are also the evidence that the API is not yet product-complete.

The UI never invents a 0–0, an empty injury list, or a fake XI.

Pages

Screen	Route	Job	Endpoints it depends on
Home	`/`	What is happening in football right now	`/fixtures/today`, `/events`, `/tournaments`
Matches	`/matches`	Browse live / today / upcoming / results	`/events`, `/fixtures/today`
Match centre	`/match/:id`	Header + tabs (overview, timeline, lineups, stats, …)	`/event/{eventId}` and the 13 event extras
Teams	`/teams`, `/team/:id`	Find a club, squad, matches, form	`/teams` and the 13 team routes
Players	`/players`, `/player/:id`	Directory and profile	`/players`, `/player/{playerId}`, player events, season stats
Manager	`/manager/:id`	Staff profile	`/manager/{managerId}`
Competitions	`/competitions`, `/competition/:id`	Directory, fixtures, table	`/tournaments` and the 6 unique-tournament routes
Search	`/search`	Find a club, player, or league by name	`/search`

Screen	Route	Job	Endpoints it depends on
Admin	`/admin/gaps`, `/coverage`, `/endpoint-lab`, `/report`	Gap dashboard and catalogue lab	same 43 routes, via the BFF

Home, when we first walked it, loaded live matches, today's list, upcoming kickoffs, finished games, and featured competitions. That one screen needed **6 provider calls** (3 of them fallbacks) and recorded **60 gaps**. That is the product working, and the API telling us what is missing.

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2. Issues we found while building the product

These showed up on real screens, not only in a catalogue sweep. A 200 was not enough. If the screen still needed a fallback, a hidden tab, or a guess, we recorded it.

Home cannot be a live scoreboard from the list

`/fixtures/today` and `/events` return teams, status, and kickoff, but **list rows often have no score**. Home had to call `/event/{id}` for each live card. That is an N+1 pattern on the first screen a user opens.

`status` is a **string** on lists and an **object** on detail. `startTimestamp` is unix seconds on lists. Featured competitions from `/tournaments` are usable, but country/region on the card was often missing, and the call was slow enough that it should not sit on the critical home path.

Product impact: Home looks like a football app. A live scoreboard cannot be built from the day's fixture list alone.

Match → Competition navigation breaks

Match detail loads. Tournament **name** can appear while `uniqueTournament.id` is **null**. The match centre cannot open the competition page unless the UI cached the id from an earlier list. That is a broken relationship, not a missing widget.

Match centre tabs are coverage-dependent

The match centre is the largest page (14 event routes). What we saw while wiring tabs:

- **Incidents** and **statistics** were strong on covered matches. Timeline is one of the best routes in the catalogue.
- **Lineups** were often an empty `{ home, away }` shell on the match Home had opened. You cannot draw a starting XI from that. A later catalogue pass found a real XI on a different, well-covered finished match. Formation and manager id were still missing.
- **Injuries**, **weather**, **pregame form**, and **H2H** came back as tiny 200 envelopes. Empty is not "no injuries," "no weather," or "no previous meetings."
- **Best players**, **team streaks**, and **typed enrichments** 404'd on the match the product opened first. The same paths returned data on a covered finished match. A 404 here looks like "match not found" unless the client special-cases the message.

- **Player-in-match stats** 404 when that player is not in the XI. Same overload: it reads as if the match is missing.
- Match **enrichments** `types` was empty on some matches and populated on others. Do not assume odds, news, or predictions live there.

Product impact: You can open a match, show teams, score (after detail), incidents, and statistics. You cannot ship a broadcast-quality match centre without hiding half the tabs, or without knowing which matches are "covered."

Team pages are the strongest family

Squad, previous/next matches, media, competitions, and standings-seasons are shippable. The squad payload is large enough to group GK / DF / MF / FW if `position` is populated.

Issues that still showed up in the product:

- Team profile has **no logo**; crests live on `/media`.
- **Featured-event** returns a match but does not mean "currently live." `/near-events` is the better "what's next" API.
- Rankings and performance need a documented **scope** (which competition, which window).
- Team season statistics **404** if you pair a team with a tournament/season it does not play. When the triple actually matches, the route works.

Player pages are thin; manager is a dead end

You can open a player and see recent matches. Country, date of birth, photo, height, and shirt number are not guaranteed. Season statistics 404 even when the player, league, and season look related. The client has to guess the tournament + season triple.

Lineups and match detail did not emit a manager id we could resolve. `/manager/{id}` 404s without one. The manager screen is not shippable.

Search finds real names, not typos

Exact and partial club / player / competition names resolve. A misspelling does not. Hits need `type`, `id`, and `name`. Duplicate rows should be unique.

Schema and list-key drift (every screen paid for this)

The BFF exists because the catalogue does not unwrap the same way twice:

Feed	List key
Search, today, `/events`, directories	`items`
Team / player / competition matches	`events`
Squad	`players`
Match timeline	`incidents`
Player match stats	`playerStatistics`

Feed	List key
Seasons	`seasons`
Standings	`standings` (groups, not a page of rows)

A client that only reads `items` will silently drop squad, timeline, and player stats.

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3. How we tested

Testing was done in layers. Together they are the basis of this report.

1. **Product walk.** We built the screens, opened Home → match → team → player → competition → search, and recorded a gap whenever a widget was empty, hidden, or assembled from extra calls.
2. **Catalogue sweep.** Every one of the 43 routes was called with real ids from search and directories — not invented ids.
3. **Depth pass.** Pagination (page 1 vs page 2 vs a huge page), status filters (`notstarted` / `inprogress` / `finished`), `last` / `next`, standings `total` / `home` / `away`, and error cases (missing `q`, non-numeric id, unknown id, bad date, invalid direction, invalid standings type).
4. **Coverage pass.** The same match extra was tried on several matches. That is how we learned lineups / best-players / streaks are not "broken" on every match and not "working" on every match either.

We did not treat HTTP 200 as a pass. A 200 with an empty envelope is **Empty**. A 404 on an optional extra is **Not available**, not "match missing."

Result	Meaning
Works	200 with data a screen can show
Partial	200, but the screen still needs extra calls, hiding, or guessing
Empty	200 with nothing useful. Not the same as "no injuries" or "no weather"
Not available	404 on an optional extra. The parent match / player / team still exists
Expected	400 or 404 on a bad request (missing query, non-numeric id, bad date, bad enum)

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4. Pagination

List routes use **1-based** `page` and `limit`, and usually return the list plus `total`, `totalPages`, and `hasMore`.

What we confirmed:

- Page 2 returns a **different slice**, not a repeat of page 1, on `/events`, `/fixtures/today`, `/teams`, `/players`, `/tournaments`, team matches, player matches, competition matches, seasons, and team media.
- A huge page number returns **200 with an empty list**, not 404. That is the right behaviour.

- Search needs `q` of **2–80 characters** (letters, numbers, spaces, `'`, `.`, `-`). A one-character query is rejected. An out-of-range search page is empty 200.
- Squad (`/team/{id}/players`), match enrichments, and standings groups are **not paginated** even when the payload is large. Squad is a single dump.
- Match **incidents** and **player-statistics** are paginated. A timeline or player-stats tab that only reads page 1 will be incomplete. Default page size on incidents is small.

`direction` on match lists is `last` or `next` . Anything else is 400.

`standings/{type}` is `total` , `home` , or `away` . Anything else is 400.

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5. Errors

These are reliable and should be handled as client mistakes or missing extras, not as "the feed is down."

Situation	HTTP	Behaviour
Search with no `q`	400	Validation message about allowed characters and length. It does not simply say "q is required."
Non-numeric id (`/event/abc`)	400	Numeric string expected
Unknown match / team / player id	404	Named "was not found"
Invalid calendar date	400	Expected `YYYY-MM-DD`
Invalid `direction`	400	Enum expected
Invalid standings type	400	Enum expected
Optional extra not on file (best players, streaks, season stats, player-in-match stats)	404	Looks like the parent entity is missing unless the client special-cases the message
Empty extras (weather, h2h, lineups on an uncovered match)	200	Tiny envelope. Easy to misread as "no weather" or "no injuries"

Improvement: optional extras should return **200 empty** with a reason (`unsupported` , `not_in_match` , `no_coverage`). Reserve 404 for "this match / player / team does not exist."

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6. Catalogue results

Paths are relative to `/v1/football` . Every route below was called. Match extras are **state and coverage dependent**: on a finished, well-covered match, lineups, incidents, statistics, best players, and streaks all loaded. On other matches the same paths were an empty shell or a 404.

Lists and search

Endpoint	Data type	Result	Pagination	Proper data?	Missing / issues	Improvement
`/search`	Paginated hit list (`items`)	**Works**	Yes. `q` required, 2–80 chars. Out-of-range page → empty 200	Yes for real names (club, player, competition). Hits carry id / name / type	Misspellings do not resolve. Duplicate hits possible	Fuzzy / alias search. Keep `type` on every row
`/events`	Paginated match list (`items`)	**Partial**	Yes. `status` = `notstarted` | `inprogress` | `finished` all return data. Page 2 is a new slice	Teams, status, kickoff. Live / finished / upcoming filters work	**Score is often missing on the row.** Status is a string here, an object on detail	Put score, minute, and competition on every list row. One status object everywhere
`/fixtures/today`	Paginated match list (`items`)	**Partial**	Yes. Page 2 does not overlap page 1	Today's card works as a schedule	Same missing score. Home cannot be a live scoreboard without N+1 `/event/{id}`	Same as `/events` — scores on the list
`/players`	Paginated directory (`items`)	**Works**	Yes	Name + id at directory scale	Cards are thin (no photo, team, or position)	Add photo, current team, position
`/teams`	Paginated directory (`items`)	**Works**	Yes	Name + id	No crest / country on the card	Add logo and country
`/tournaments`	Paginated directory (`items`)	**Works**	Yes	Competition names	Region / country often missing	Add category, country, logo

Match centre

Endpoint	Data type	Result	Pagination	Proper data?	Missing / issues	Improvement
`/event/{eventId}`	Match object (`event`)	**Works** / **Partial** in the product	No	Header is usable: teams, status object, score, tournament	Tournament **name** can appear while tournament **id** is null, which breaks Match → Competition	Always emit `uniqueTournament.id` with the name. ISO kickoff on list and detail
`/event/{eventId}/best-players`	Best player + leaderboard	**Works** when covered; **Not available** (404) otherwise	Leaderboard is paged	Home / away best player and a ranking list on a covered finished match	Ranking rule is not documented. 404 on uncovered matches	200 empty when not covered. Document what "best" means
`/event/{eventId}/enrichments`	Type list (`types`)	**Works** when covered; **Empty** otherwise	Not paged	Covered matches list extras (average positions, best players, highlights, shotmap, streaks, votes, …)	Empty `types` on other matches looks like "no extras exist in the product"	Publish the type catalogue. Empty list = no extras **on this match**
`/event/{eventId}/enrichments/{type}`	Typed extra (shape depends on type)	**Works** when the type exists; **Not available** (404) otherwise	Depends on type	First listed type returned a real payload on a covered match	404 if you guess a type that is not on this match	200 empty for unknown / unsupported type
`/event/{eventId}/h2h`	Head-to-head object	**Empty**	No	Keys exist (`teamDuel` , `managerDuel`)	No previous-meetings list, no event ids to open	Return historical matches with `eventId` , or a documented empty object

Endpoint	Data type	Result	Pagination	Proper data?	Missing / issues	Improvement
`/event/{eventId}/incidents`	Paginated timeline (`incidents`)	**Works**	Yes — page 1 is not the full match	Goals, cards, substitutions on a covered match	Player / team id is not always obvious next to the name. Page size is small	Guarantee `playerId` and `teamId` . Default a larger page or cursor
`/event/{eventId}/injuries`	Home / away envelope	**Partial**	No	Covered match returns a non-empty envelope	Empty envelope on other matches. Empty is **not** "nobody is injured"	`{ coverage, home, away }` . Never imply a clean bill of health
`/event/{eventId}/lineups`	Home / away envelope	**Partial**	No	Covered finished match returns a real XI	Formation and manager id often missing. Uncovered / not-started matches return an empty home/away shell	11 starters, bench, shirts, positions, formation, coach, confirmed vs expected. Empty shell needs a coverage flag
`/event/{eventId}/player-statistics`	Paginated player stats	**Works** when covered; **Empty** otherwise	Yes	Per-player match figures on a covered match	List key is `playerStatistics` , not `items` . Easy to miss if the client only unwraps `items`	Keep one list key across the catalogue, or document this key
`/event/{eventId}/player/{playerId}/statistics`	Player match stats	**Not available** if that player is not in the match	No	—	404 reads as "match missing"	200 `{ available: false, reason: "player_not_in_match" }`
`/event/{eventId}/pregame-form`	Home / away form	**Works** when populated; **Empty** otherwise	No	Recent form can appear	Tiny empty envelope on other matches	Always return last-N results, or `{ available: false }`
`/event/{eventId}/statistics`	Match statistics object	**Works**	No	Strong payload on a covered match	Uncovered matches return almost nothing. Empty stats ≠ 0% possession	Keep the shape stable. Never fake zeros
`/event/{eventId}/team-streaks`	Streak / H2H summary	**Works** when covered; **Not available** (404) otherwise	No	General and head-to-head windows on a covered match	404 on uncovered matches	200 empty. Document the window
`/event/{eventId}/weather`	Weather object	**Empty**	No	Envelope only (`conditions`)	Cannot tell "not provided" from "clear conditions"	Coverage flag. Do not ship a weather tab on an empty object

Player and manager

Endpoint	Data type	Result	Pagination	Proper data?	Missing / issues	Improvement
`/player/{playerId}`	Player object (`player`)	**Partial**	No	Name and enough to open a profile	Country and date of birth often missing. Photo / height / shirt are not guaranteed	Fill the career card. Missing fields stay missing in the UI — do not invent them
`/player/{playerId}/events/{direction}`	Paginated match list (`events`)	**Works**	Yes. `last` / `next` only	Recent list is large and usable. Upcoming can be a short list	Upcoming rows have no score (fair). Invalid direction → 400. No player-level figures on the row	Do not put the player's own match figures on these rows unless documented
`/player/{playerId}/unique-tournament/{tournamentId}/season/{seasonId}/statistics`	Season statistics object	**Works** or **Not available**	No	Returns player / team / statistics when the file exists	404 even when the player, league, and season look related. Clients have to guess the triple	A player-level stats index. 200 empty when not on file
`/manager/{managerId}`	Manager object	**Not available**	No	—	Lineups and match detail did not emit a manager id we could resolve	Emit manager id from lineup / team. Only then is this route useful

Team

This is the strongest family in the catalogue.

Endpoint	Data type	Result	Pagination	Proper data?	Missing / issues	Improvement
`/team/{teamId}`	Team object (`team`)	**Partial**	No	Name and profile header	Logo missing on the profile (images live on `/media`)	Put crest on the team object
`/team/{teamId}/players`	Squad list (`players`)	**Works**	**No** — one large dump	Full squad. Positions exist so you can group GK / DF / MF / FW	Player id/name sit nested, not always on the top row	Paginate or document "full dump." Keep `position` populated
`/team/{teamId}/events/{direction}`	Paginated match list (`events`)	**Works**	Yes	Previous and upcoming lists are real	Upcoming rows have no score	Same list-score improvement as `/events`
`/team/{teamId}/featured-event`	Match object	**Works**	No	Returns a match	Meaning is unclear — not "currently live"	Document as editorial. Prefer `/near-events` for "what's next"
`/team/{teamId}/near-events`	Previous / next match	**Works**	No	Clear `previousEvent` / `nextEvent`	—	Keep this as the "what's next" API
`/team/{teamId}/performance`	Form list + points	**Works**	Yes	Recent form window	Ranking / competition scope is not obvious	Document the window and competition
`/team/{teamId}/rankings`	Paginated rankings	**Works**	Yes	Ranking rows exist	Context (which ranking list?) is unclear	Name the ranking and the date
`/team/{teamId}/unique-tournaments`	Paginated competitions	**Works**	Yes	Needed to discover `tournamentId` for later stats	—	—
`/team/{teamId}/standings-seasons`	Paginated season links	**Works**	Yes	Use this instead of guessing season ids	Two keys (`uniqueTournamentSeasons` , `tournamentSeasons`)	Prefer one list key
`/team/{teamId}/unique-tournament/{tournamentId}/season/{seasonId}/statistics`	Season statistics object	**Works** when the triple matches; **Not available** otherwise	No	Usable when the team actually plays that competition/season	404 if you pair a random team with a random league	200 empty, or publish which triples exist
`/team/{teamId}/media`	Paginated media	**Works**	Yes	Crest / images	Profile still has no logo field	Reuse these URLs on `/team/{id}`
`/team/{teamId}/enrichments`	Type list	**Works**	Not paged	Types are listed (unlike many match enrichment indexes)	—	Keep match-side enrichments this consistent
`/team/{teamId}/enrichments/{type}`	Typed extra (often an event list)	**Works**	Yes for event-shaped types	Real payload for a listed type	Shape changes by type	Document each type

Competition

Endpoint	Data type	Result	Pagination	Proper data?	Missing / issues	Improvement
`/unique-tournament/{tournamentId}`	Competition object	**Partial**	No	Name and overview	`currentSeasonId` can be missing — you must call `/seasons`	Always emit current season

Endpoint	Data type	Result	Pagination	Proper data?	Missing / issues	Improvement
`/unique-tournament/{tournamentId}/events`	Paginated match list (`events`)	**Works**	Yes	Large, usable fixture/result list	Can include old seasons if not filtered	Document default season
`/unique-tournament/{tournamentId}/scheduled-events/{date}`	Paginated match list	**Empty** on a quiet day; **Expected** 400 on a bad date	Yes	Empty day is valid. Bad date is clearly `YYYY-MM-DD`	Empty day vs "this league is not covered that day" is still ambiguous	Coverage flag on empty days
`/unique-tournament/{tournamentId}/seasons`	Paginated seasons	**Works**	Yes	Source of truth for season ids	—	Never hardcode seasons
`/unique-tournament/{tournamentId}/season/{seasonId}/round/{round}`	Paginated matchday list	**Works**	Yes	Round 1 returned a full match list	Whether `round` is a number, a name, or both is not documented	Document round identity
`/unique-tournament/{tournamentId}/season/{seasonId}/standings/{type}`	Standings groups	**Works**	Not paged as a list of pages	`total` , `home` , and `away` all returned tables on a major league	Cup competitions will not look like a league table. Goal difference is not guaranteed	Do not force GD / home / away columns. Document `type`

7. What a football product can ship today

Need	Ready?	What we saw in the product and in testing
Today's matches	Yes	`/fixtures/today` works as a schedule
Live scores on the home card	Partial	Live filter works. The list often has no score. Home did N+1 detail calls
Match timeline	Yes, on covered matches	Incidents are paginated — read every page
Match statistics	Yes, on covered matches	Strong payload. Do not hardcode metrics. Do not fake 0%
Lineups	Partial	Real XI on some finished matches. Empty shell on others. Formation / manager often missing
Injuries / weather / H2H	Weak	Empty 200 or a thin envelope. Do not claim "none"
Best players / streaks	Coverage-dependent	200 on a covered match, 404 on others
Team squad and match lists	Yes	Strongest part of the API
League table	Yes	`standings/total` is usable. Home / away worked on a major league
Search	Partial	Real names work. Typos do not. `q` is required
Manager page	No	No reliable id from lineup / match, and the route 404s without one
Player season stats	Partial	Works for some triples, 404 for others that look valid
Odds / news / predictions	Unknown	Enrichment types are empty on some matches. Do not assume they exist

8. What is missing, and what to improve

Highest value first.

1. **Scores on list rows.** `/fixtures/today` and `/events` should include score, minute, and competition. That removes N+1 detail calls on Home.
2. **One event schema.** Status object and ISO kickoff on both list and detail. Always emit tournament id with the name so Match → Competition works.
3. **Optional extras must not 404.** Best players, streaks, enrichment types, player-in-match stats, missing season stats: return 200 empty with a reason. 404 is for "this match does not exist."
4. **Empty vs unsupported.** Weather, injuries, lineups, form, H2H, scheduled-events: add an explicit coverage flag. An empty 200 is currently ambiguous.
5. **Lineups that can draw an XI.** Starters, bench, shirts, positions, formation, coach, confirmed vs expected — on every covered match, and an honest empty state otherwise.
6. **One list key, or document them.** `items` vs `events` vs `players` vs `playerStatistics` vs `incidents`. Paginate or document the squad dump. Incidents default page is too small for a full timeline.
7. **Search quality.** Aliases and misspellings are part of a football product.
8. **Manager id on the lineup.** Without it, `/manager/{id}` is a dead route.
9. **Do not 404 season statistics** for a valid player or team that simply has no file for that tournament/season. Publish which triples exist, or return coverage.
10. **Document ranking / "best" / featured-event.** If the API cannot say what the field means, the UI must not guess.
11. **Crest on the team object.** Images already exist on `/media`.
12. **Current season on the competition object.** Clients should not have to call `/seasons` just to know which table to load.

The Football API is good enough to start a product. Search, teams, competitions, standings, match detail, incidents, and statistics are shippable. A complete match centre still depends on coverage, and several extras still fail as 404 or empty 200 instead of a clear "not on this match." The screens we built only render what the API gave us.

Product assessment from live REST calls against the Football catalogue and a working Football Lab product.